with an apocalyptic sense of doom within. But on the other hand, this perception was also methodically fomented by the BJP's propaganda machinery.

Yet, from reading Utkarsha Rupwate's, Sasikanth Senthil's or Mahima Singh's essays, it is clear that every aspect of the BJY—from organizing the logistics (stay, food and transportation of baggage) to arranging the interactions, reaching out to civil society organizations and people's movements, social media and communications, security, etc.—was meticulously managed by party functionaries. In state after state, the Congress found numerous political entrepreneurs in the organization who were exceptionally dynamic and motivated. While senior party leaders oversaw every minute detail, they empowered younger stakeholders to experiment and learn through their mistakes. The BJY thus forced the Congress party to confront and reform weaknesses that had crept in. Years of bureaucratic inertia were swept away with this radically disruptive movement, which compelled the party to remember its vibrancy and return to its foundational principles. And the credit for this must go to former Congress president Rahul Gandhi, who has done a historic service to the grand old party of India.

The Yatra was also a crash course in human psychology. It enabled us to minutely observe (albeit in a limited capacity) not just the yatris and other organizers, but also thousands of people who came to interact with the Congress party (both in closed-door and walking interactions). One thing was abundantly clear, something that many in the media have missed (either because of the blinkers they have chosen to put on or because of fault lines in how the media is structured). Millions of Indians are struggling with deep-seated problems (both structural and from the past decade) that are not being addressed, some poignantly captured in Meenakshi Natarajan's, Nikhil Dey's and Medha Patkar-Guddi's essays. People feel unheard and ignored. And they are gasping for someone to pay heed. And Rahul Gandhi did not just mindfully hear them, but also gave them hope of a better future.

But it must be conceded that something has also changed in India's mass consciousness. This is a generalization that may not be universally